

GameCo Regional Sales Review

Excel Analysis Workstream

Client	GameCo	Project Type	Excel-based business analysis
Primary Audience	Executive board and marketing strategy stakeholders	Primary Tooling	Microsoft Excel, Pivot Tables, Charts, PowerPoint
Focus Period	Historical sales through 2016 to inform 2017 planning	Deliverables	Executive presentation, prepared dataset, analysis workbooks, visuals

Executive Summary

GameCo is reviewing whether regional sales patterns in the video game market have remained stable enough to support its current marketing allocation strategy. This project brief outlines the Excel analysis workstream used to test that assumption using historical video game sales data. The analysis focuses on regional sales mix, genre performance, platform trends, descriptive analysis, and insight development to support budget planning for 2017 and beyond.

Business Context

GameCo's executive board was preparing the 2017 marketing budget in October 2016 and wanted to understand whether the company's historic sales profile still justified its existing regional focus. Leadership assumed that the proportions of global sales generated by the major markets had remained broadly stable over time. The analysis workstream was therefore designed to evaluate that assumption and identify whether recent market behaviour suggested the need for a revised planning approach.

Project Objectives

- Prepare and structure the available video game sales dataset in Excel for reproducible analysis.
- Assess data quality, identify issues affecting interpretation, and create a prepared working dataset.
- Use pivot tables, filters, grouping logic, descriptive analysis, and charts to evaluate market behaviour across regions, genres, publishers, platforms, and years.
- Test whether regional sales proportions changed over time and identify findings relevant to 2017 marketing allocation.
- Package the outputs in a business-facing format that supports executive discussion and portfolio-ready documentation.

Key Business Questions

#	Question
1	Have North America, Europe, and Japan maintained the same share of global sales over time?
2	Which genres and platforms contributed most strongly to sales performance in the 2016 planning window?
3	Do regional genre preferences differ enough to affect marketing priorities by market?
4	Are there observable patterns in the relationship between title volume and sales outcomes?
5	What should GameCo revise in its current understanding before finalising 2017 budget allocation?

Data Scope

The analysis is based on a historical video game sales dataset containing game title, platform, year of release, genre, publisher, and regional sales fields including North America, Europe, Japan, Other Regions, and Global Sales. Because the source is spreadsheet-based rather than relational, the workstream places strong emphasis on Excel-based preparation, structured filtering, pivot-table summarisation, and visual analysis before final reporting.

Core Fields Reviewed

Name, Platform, Year, Genre, Publisher, NA_Sales, EU_Sales, JP_Sales, Other_Sales, Global_Sales

Analytical Approach

Workstream Stage	Description
Data inspection	Review workbook structure, inspect field meanings, sort and filter key dimensions, and document initial observations.
Data cleaning	Identify missing values, redundant fields, and inconsistencies; create a cleaner and more analysis-ready dataset.
Pivot analysis	Use pivot tables, slicers, counts, averages, grouped categories, and calculated fields to create business summaries.
EDA and descriptive analysis	Assess central tendency, distribution, spread, and unusual values before making final claims.
Insight development	Evaluate whether current assumptions about regional market behaviour match the evidence in the data.
Communication	Present findings through clear visuals, structured narrative, and an executive-facing final presentation.

Planned Deliverables

- Executive presentation summarizing the business context, analysis visuals, insight, revised understanding, and recommended action.
- Prepared Excel dataset showing the transition from raw data to a cleaned and analysis-ready working file.
- Analysis workbooks documenting cleaning, pivot-table modelling, descriptive analysis, and visual development.
- Curated charts and screenshots supporting the main business narrative and technical traceability.

Success Criteria

The workstream will be considered successful if it produces reliable Excel-based outputs that answer the core business questions clearly, demonstrates structured analytical reasoning, and delivers materials that are useful to both executive stakeholders and technical reviewers.

Working Assumptions

Area	Assumption
Data availability	The provided sales dataset contains sufficient fields to evaluate regional mix, category performance, and trend direction.
Data quality	Some cleaning, validation, and interpretation checks are required before the data can support final reporting.
Audience needs	Executives require concise insights and clear visuals; supporting workbooks should retain enough traceability to show how conclusions were reached.

Prepared as a professional project brief for portfolio presentation and project documentation.